



▲ HEAVY DRAGOON CARBINE PATTERN 1796

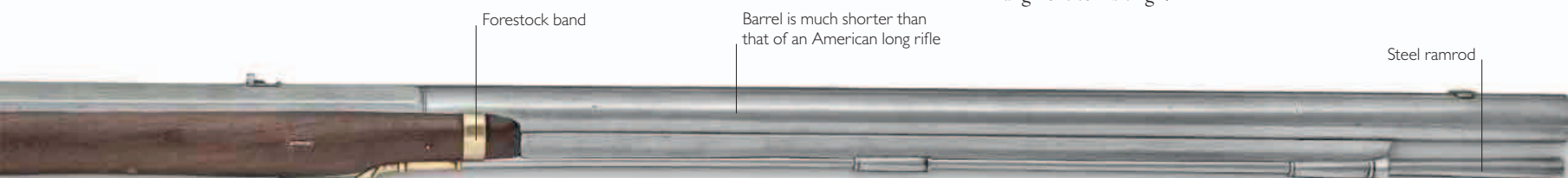
Date c.1805

Origin UK

Barrel 26in (66cm)

Caliber .75in (19mm)

Napoleonic-era carbines such as this one had shorter barrels than earlier models. Dragoons were mounted infantry, and while on horseback, each dragoon clipped the carbine to his belt, from which it hung next to his thigh.



▲ HARPER'S FERRY RIFLE

Date 1814

Origin US

Barrel 35½in (90cm)

Caliber .54in (13.7mm)

Following the success of American riflemen during the American Revolutionary War (1775–83), it was surprising that the first official US military rifle followed a European design rather than that of the traditional long rifle (see pp.96–97). Introduced in 1803, this rifle was built at the US Armory at Harpers Ferry (in modern-day West Virginia).



▲ HALL RIFLE

Date 1819

Origin US

Barrel 32½in (82.5cm)

Caliber .54in (13.7mm)

John Hancock Hall's rifle, designed in 1811 and introduced into service in 1819, was the first regulation American rifle that was loaded at the breech; hinged at the front, it tipped up at a 30-degree angle for loading. Hall rifles and carbines were eventually produced in percussion form (see pp.80–81), too, where the entire breech unit could be removed and used as a pistol. Many breech-loading guns of the flintlock period had cleaning rods instead of the ramrods seen in muzzle-loaders.

